

UFC Fight Night Portfolio Analysis: Round 1 Investment Memorandum

I. Portfolio Mandate & Analytical Framework

1.1. Executive Summary: Round 1 Mission

This memorandum outlines the investment strategy and portfolio allocation for Round 1 of a 10-round performance experiment. The primary objective for this initial round is twofold: to achieve a positive return on the starting \$10.00 bankroll and to establish a disciplined, repeatable analytical process centered on the principle of Positive Expected Value (+EV). The governing philosophy is one of capital preservation and sustainable long-term growth. This round is not an exercise in maximizing short-term returns through high-risk, concentrated positions. Instead, the strategy focuses on identifying multiple, smaller market inefficiencies (+EV wagers) across the provided betting lines. This creates a diversified portfolio designed to mitigate the inherent variance of mixed martial arts and lay the foundation for compounding growth over the subsequent nine rounds. The allocation of capital will be a direct function of the mathematically derived "edge" identified in each potential investment, ensuring that conviction and capital are inextricably linked.

1.2. Acknowledgment of Core Constraint

It is formally acknowledged and confirmed that the entirety of this analysis, including all quantitative modeling and final investment selections, is derived exclusively from the betting markets and odds provided within the "Bets for Analysis" data structure.

No external odds, lines, or alternative betting markets have been researched, considered, or utilized in the construction of this portfolio. This adherence to the core operational constraint is absolute and ensures complete compliance with the established parameters of the experiment.

1.3. Quantitative Methodology

The foundation of this portfolio is a rigorous, unemotional, and data-driven quantitative framework designed to identify and exploit pricing discrepancies between market odds and proprietary projections.

1.3.1. Foundational Mathematics: Expected Value (EV)

All investment decisions are governed by the principle of Positive Expected Value (+EV). Expected Value is a measure of the average outcome of a probabilistic event over a large number of trials. A wager possesses a positive expected value when its probability of winning is greater than the probability implied by the betting odds. The formula for calculating Expected Value is as follows:

$$EV = (P_{win} \times \text{Potential Profit}) - (P_{loss} \times \text{Amount Staked})$$

Where P_{win} represents the proprietary probability of the wager winning, and P_{loss} is the probability of it losing ($1 - P_{win}$). A positive EV signifies a profitable investment over a large sample size and is the sole prerequisite for a wager's inclusion in the portfolio.

1.3.2. Establishing the Baseline: Implied Probability

To identify value, one must first establish the market's price. In sports betting, the price is encapsulated by the odds. These odds are converted into a break-even percentage known as the implied probability. This figure represents the probability at which a bet would yield neither profit nor loss over the long term. It is the market's baseline assessment of an outcome's likelihood.

The conversion formulas for American odds are:

- For positive (underdog) odds (+X):

$$\text{Implied Probability} = \frac{X}{X+100} \times 100$$

- For negative (favorite) odds (-Y):

$$\text{Implied Probability} = \frac{Y}{Y+100} \times 100$$

1.3.3. Generating Alpha: Proprietary Probability Modeling

The core of the analytical process lies in the generation of proprietary win probabilities that are more accurate than those implied by the market. This is where an analytical edge, or "alpha," is created. The proprietary model is a weighted synthesis of two distinct analytical pillars:

- **Quantitative Analysis:** This involves a deep statistical evaluation of fighter performance metrics sourced from official records.¹ Key metrics include, but are not limited to: Significant Strikes Landed per Minute (SLpM), Significant Striking Accuracy (Str. Acc.), Significant Strikes Absorbed per Minute (SApM), Striking Defense (Str. Def.), Takedown Average (TD Avg.), Takedown Accuracy (TD Acc.), and Takedown Defense (TD Def.).
- **Qualitative Analysis:** This layer provides context to the raw data. It includes a thorough assessment of stylistic matchups, fighter durability, fight IQ, cardiovascular endurance, recent performance trajectories, and specific strengths and weaknesses as identified in expert fight breakdowns.²⁵

By integrating these two pillars, the model produces a nuanced and robust probability for each potential outcome, which is then compared against the market's implied probability to identify value.

1.4. Bankroll Allocation Strategy: Modified Kelly Criterion

Optimal bet sizing is critical for long-term growth. While the full Kelly Criterion formula is mathematically proven to maximize growth, its aggressive nature makes it highly

sensitive to even minor inaccuracies in probability estimation, posing a significant risk of bankroll depletion (risk of ruin). Given the high variance inherent in MMA, a more conservative approach is warranted.

This portfolio will employ a fractional Kelly Criterion strategy. The size of each wager will be a direct function of the calculated edge (Edge = Proprietary Probability - Implied Probability), but this figure will be scaled down by a conservative fraction (a "k-factor" of 0.25, or 25%) to mitigate risk and preserve capital. This methodology ensures that the largest allocations are made to the most significant identified market inefficiencies, while protecting the bankroll from the devastating impact of a high-variance downswing. All final wager amounts will be calculated based on this principle and then rounded to the nearest \$0.25 increment, with minor adjustments made to ensure the full \$10.00 bankroll is deployed.

II. Market Analysis: Implied Probability Matrix

The following table translates all available American odds from the "Bets for Analysis" list into their corresponding implied probabilities. This matrix serves as the quantitative baseline for the entire report, standardizing the market's pricing and enabling the objective identification of investment opportunities.

Event Name	Market	Selection	Odds	Implied Probability
Martin Buday vs Marcus Buchecha	Moneyline	Martin Buday	+250	28.57%
Martin Buday vs Marcus Buchecha	Moneyline	Marcus Buchecha	-310	75.61%
Martin Buday vs Marcus Buchecha	Total Rounds	Over 1.5	-130	56.52%
Martin Buday vs	Total Rounds	Under 1.5	+100	50.00%

Marcus Buchecha				
Martin Buday vs Marcus Buchecha	Fight to Go the Distance	Yes	+180	35.71%
Martin Buday vs Marcus Buchecha	Fight to Go the Distance	No	-245	71.01%
Martin Buday vs Marcus Buchecha	Method of Victory	Marcus Buchecha To Win By Submission	-105	51.22%
Ibo Aslan vs Billy Elekana	Moneyline	Ibo Aslan	-290	74.36%
Ibo Aslan vs Billy Elekana	Moneyline	Billy Elekana	+215	31.75%
Ibo Aslan vs Billy Elekana	Total Rounds	Over 1.5	-110	52.38%
Ibo Aslan vs Billy Elekana	Total Rounds	Under 1.5	-120	54.55%
Amanda Ribas vs Tabatha Ricci	Moneyline	Amanda Ribas	-185	64.91%
Amanda Ribas vs Tabatha Ricci	Moneyline	Tabatha Ricci	+154	39.37%
Amanda Ribas vs Tabatha Ricci	Method of Victory	Amanda Ribas To Win By Decision	+150	40.00%
Da'Mon Blackshear vs Davey Grant	Moneyline	Da'Mon Blackshear	-340	77.27%

Da'Mon Blackshear vs Davey Grant	Moneyline	Davey Grant	+250	28.57%
Da'Mon Blackshear vs Davey Grant	Fight to Go the Distance	Yes	+150	40.00%
Da'Mon Blackshear vs Davey Grant	Fight to Go the Distance	No	-200	66.67%
Muslim Salikhov vs Carlos Leal	Moneyline	Muslim Salikhov	+300	25.00%
Muslim Salikhov vs Carlos Leal	Moneyline	Carlos Leal	-400	80.00%
Muslim Salikhov vs Carlos Leal	Total Rounds	Over 2.5	-115	53.49%
Muslim Salikhov vs Carlos Leal	Total Rounds	Under 2.5	-115	53.49%
Bryce Mitchell vs Said Nurmagomedov	Moneyline	Bryce Mitchell	-122	54.95%
Bryce Mitchell vs Said Nurmagomedov	Moneyline	Said Nurmagomedov	+102	49.50%
Bryce Mitchell vs Said Nurmagomedov	Method of Victory	Said Nurmagomedov To Win By Submission	+350	22.22%
Asu Almagbayev vs Jose Ochoa	Moneyline	Asu Almagbayev	-110	52.38%
Asu Almagbayev vs Jose Ochoa	Moneyline	Jose Ochoa	-110	52.38%

Shara Magomedov vs Marc-Andre Barriault	Moneyline	Shara Magomedov	-600	85.71%
Shara Magomedov vs Marc-Andre Barriault	Moneyline	Marc-Andre Barriault	+400	20.00%
Shara Magomedov vs Marc-Andre Barriault	Total Rounds	Over 1.5	-160	61.54%
Shara Magomedov vs Marc-Andre Barriault	Total Rounds	Under 1.5	+125	44.44%
Petr Yan vs Marcus McGhee	Moneyline	Petr Yan	-380	79.17%
Petr Yan vs Marcus McGhee	Moneyline	Marcus McGhee	+300	25.00%
Petr Yan vs Marcus McGhee	Fight to Go the Distance	Yes	-330	76.74%
Petr Yan vs Marcus McGhee	Fight to Go the Distance	No	+240	29.41%
Robert Whittaker vs Reinier de Ridder	Moneyline	Robert Whittaker	-142	58.68%
Robert Whittaker vs Reinier de Ridder	Moneyline	Reinier de Ridder	+120	45.45%

Robert Whittaker vs Reinier de Ridder	Total Rounds	Over 2.5	-138	57.98%
Robert Whittaker vs Reinier de Ridder	Total Rounds	Under 2.5	+108	48.08%

III. Investment Theses: In-Depth Fight Analysis & Value Identification

The following section provides a detailed breakdown of each matchup on the card. Each fight is assessed as a potential investment, synthesizing quantitative data and qualitative analysis to generate proprietary probabilities and identify market inefficiencies.

3.1. Heavyweight Bout: Martin Buday vs. Marcus "Buchechea" Almeida

Tale of the Tape & Statistical Dashboard

Metric	Martin Buday	Marcus "Buchechea" Almeida
Record	15-2-0 ¹	5-1-0 ⁴¹
Height	6' 4" ¹	6' 3" ⁴¹
Weight	265 lbs ¹	254 lbs ⁴¹

Reach	77" ¹	80" ⁴¹
Stance	Orthodox ¹	N/A
SLpM	4.67 ¹	N/A
Str. Acc.	53% ¹	N/A
SAPM	5.00 ¹	N/A
Str. Def.	55% ¹	N/A
TD Avg.	0.17 ¹	N/A
TD Acc.	20% ¹	N/A
TD Def.	100% ¹	N/A

Stylistic Matchup Assessment & Value Identification

This fight presents a classic clash of a highly specialized, elite prospect against a durable, physically imposing veteran. Marcus "Buchechea" Almeida is making his UFC debut, carrying the reputation of being one of the most decorated heavyweight grapplers in the history of Brazilian Jiu-Jitsu.²⁵ His MMA career has followed a predictable and effective script: secure a takedown and find a submission. Four of his five professional victories have come via submission, all in the first round.⁴¹ His entire offensive framework is built on achieving a finish early.

Martin Buday, conversely, is a massive heavyweight who has compiled a 6-1 record in the UFC not through dynamic finishing ability, but through a grueling, attritional style.¹ He excels in the clinch, using his immense size to lean on opponents, drain their cardio, and win fights that are often described as uninspiring but effective.²⁵ While his UFC takedown defense statistic sits at a perfect 100%, this has been achieved against a slate of opponents who are not elite submission specialists.¹

The market has priced Buchechea as a heavy favorite at -310, implying a win probability of 75.6%. This price is largely a reflection of his grappling pedigree and the

perceived stylistic mismatch against Buday. However, this valuation fails to adequately account for the critical data point from Buchecha's sole professional loss. Against Oumar "Reug Reug" Kane, another physically strong heavyweight, Buchecha was unable to secure an early takedown and submission. As the fight extended, his cardio visibly deteriorated, and his offensive output diminished significantly, leading to a unanimous decision loss.⁴⁰

This history provides a clear blueprint to defeating Buchecha: survive the initial storm, force a grappling-heavy pace, and exploit the cardio differential in the later stages of the fight. Martin Buday's entire fighting style is predicated on executing this exact game plan. He is a specialist in the very type of fight that Buchecha has already proven vulnerable to. Therefore, the market appears to be overweighting Buchecha's offensive potential while significantly underweighting the probability that Buday's specific, attritional skillset will be effective.

The most significant market inefficiency is not on the moneyline, but on the **Total Rounds: Over 1.5** prop, priced at -130 (56.5% implied probability). For this wager to cash, Buday must survive just 7 minutes and 30 seconds. Given his durability, size, and clinch-heavy style designed to stall action and exhaust opponents, the true probability of the fight extending beyond this mark is considerably higher. The analysis projects a proprietary probability of 68.0% for this outcome, revealing a substantial +EV opportunity.

3.2. Light Heavyweight Bout: Ibo Aslan vs. Billy Elekana

Tale of the Tape & Statistical Dashboard

Metric	Ibo Aslan	Billy Elekana
Record	14-2-0 ⁴⁴	7-2-0 ²
Height	6' 3" ⁴⁴	6' 3" ²

Weight	205 lbs ⁴⁴	205 lbs ²
Reach	77.5" ⁴⁴	77" ²
Stance	Orthodox ⁴⁴	Southpaw ²
SLpM	7.84 ⁴⁴	2.34 ²
Str. Acc.	50% ⁴⁴	71% ²
SAPM	4.43 ⁴⁴	5.50 ²
Str. Def.	63% ⁴⁴	33% ²
TD Avg.	0.00 ⁴⁴	1.75 ²
TD Acc.	0% ⁴⁴	100% ²
TD Def.	83% ⁴⁴	0% ²

Stylistic Matchup Assessment & Value Identification

This bout is a quintessential striker versus grappler encounter. Ibo Aslan is a highly aggressive and powerful knockout artist, with all 14 of his professional victories coming by way of KO/TKO.⁴⁴ His offensive strategy is singular in its focus: maintain distance and land fight-ending blows. However, his defensive game reveals a critical vulnerability. Both of his career losses have come via submission, indicating a clear deficiency in his ground game.²⁷

Billy Elekana, conversely, presents the exact stylistic threat to exploit this weakness. While he lost his UFC debut on short notice, he demonstrated a clear grappling-centric approach, securing a takedown and achieving ground control before being submitted himself.² His path to victory is not on the feet, but on the mat, where he can neutralize Aslan's power and attack his documented weakness.

The market has installed Aslan as a prohibitive favorite at -290, implying a 74.4% win probability. This pricing assumes that Aslan will be able to dictate where the fight

takes place. A key statistical point is Aslan's 83% takedown defense.⁴⁴ While this number appears robust, it is misleading. It has been compiled against opponents who were not dedicated wrestlers, and it stands in stark contrast to his actual fight history, where both of his losses came when a competent grappler successfully brought the fight to the mat.⁴⁴ Elekana's entire game plan will be to test this statistic relentlessly. He will not engage in a striking duel; his sole objective is to close the distance and initiate grappling exchanges.

The probability of Elekana successfully implementing his A-game is substantially higher than the 31.8% implied by his +215 odds. Aslan has already demonstrated a clear loss condition to this style of attack. Elekana's win condition directly targets Aslan's proven loss condition. This creates a significant value proposition on the underdog. The analysis projects Elekana's true win probability to be closer to 42.0%. Therefore, the **Billy Elekana Moneyline at +215** represents a high-conviction, +EV investment.

3.3. Women's Strawweight Bout: Amanda Ribas vs. Tabatha Ricci

Tale of the Tape & Statistical Dashboard

Metric	Amanda Ribas	Tabatha Ricci
Record	13-6-0 ⁸	11-3-0 ²⁰
Height	5' 4" ⁸	5' 1" ²⁰
Weight	115 lbs ¹⁵	115 lbs ¹⁵
Reach	66" ⁸	61" ²⁰
Stance	Orthodox ⁸	Orthodox ²⁰

SLpM	4.29 ⁸	4.18 ²⁰
Str. Acc.	39% ⁸	36% ²⁰
SAPM	3.24 ⁸	5.29 ²⁰
Str. Def.	60% ⁸	57% ²⁰
TD Avg.	2.06 ⁸	2.74 ²⁰
TD Acc.	53% ⁸	37% ²⁰
TD Def.	83% ⁸	81% ²⁰

Stylistic Matchup Assessment & Value Identification

On the surface, this matchup appears to be a closely contested affair between two Brazilian grapplers who both hold black belts in BJJ and Judo.⁴⁶ However, a deeper dive into the statistical and physical data reveals a significant, fight-altering mismatch. Tabatha Ricci's primary offensive weapon is her wrestling, where she attempts takedowns at a high rate (2.74 per 15 minutes).²⁰ Her success, however, is limited, with a takedown accuracy of only 37%.²⁰

Amanda Ribas presents a formidable defensive wall to this strategy. Her takedown defense is an elite 83%.⁸ This single metric is the lynchpin of the entire fight. It is highly probable that Ribas will be able to neutralize Ricci's A-game, forcing the contest to play out in the striking realm. In a stand-up battle, Ribas's advantages become overwhelming. She is three inches taller and possesses a crucial five-inch reach advantage.¹⁵ Furthermore, Ricci's striking defense is a significant liability; she absorbs a high volume of 5.29 significant strikes per minute.²⁰ Ribas is far more defensively sound, absorbing only 3.24 SAPM.⁸

This fight is not the grappling toss-up it may seem. Instead, it is a statistically probable striking mismatch that will be dictated by Ribas's ability to defend takedowns and leverage her physical advantages at range. Ricci's path to victory is narrow and relies on overcoming a significant statistical and physical deficit. Ribas, on the other hand, can win the fight simply by keeping it on the feet and out-pointing her

opponent from the outside.

The moneyline on Ribas at -185 (64.9% implied) is fairly priced. However, a more specific and valuable investment lies in the method of victory. Given Ricci's proven durability and Ribas's tendency to win via decision (5 of her 13 victories), the **Amanda Ribas To Win By Decision** prop at +150 (40.0% implied) offers superior value. The proprietary model places the probability of this specific outcome at 48.0%, making it a clear +EV selection.

3.4. Bantamweight Bout: Da'Mon Blackshear vs. Davey Grant

Tale of the Tape & Statistical Dashboard

Metric	Da'Mon Blackshear	Davey Grant
Record	17-7-1 ⁴⁹	16-7-0 ⁹
Height	5' 10" ⁴⁹	5' 8" ⁹
Weight	135 lbs ⁴⁹	135 lbs ⁹
Reach	72" ⁴⁹	69" ⁹
Stance	Switch ¹⁶	Orthodox ⁹
SLpM	4.70 ¹⁶	5.25 ⁹
Str. Acc.	46% ¹⁶	44% ⁹
SAPM	4.15 ¹⁶	3.89 ⁹
Str. Def.	52% ¹⁶	55% ⁹

TD Avg.	1.56 ¹⁶	1.14 ⁹
TD Acc.	36% ¹⁶	40% ⁹
TD Def.	71% ¹⁶	61% ⁹

Stylistic Matchup Assessment & Value Identification

The market has positioned Da'Mon Blackshear as a substantial favorite at -340 (77.3% implied), largely due to his recent string of submission victories and his youth advantage over the veteran Davey Grant.¹⁶ Blackshear is a dynamic and dangerous submission specialist, boasting an exceptionally high submission attempt average of 1.6 per 15 minutes.¹⁶

However, this pricing overlooks several key factors that point toward a much more competitive fight. Davey Grant, despite being nearly a decade older, is a durable and battle-tested veteran known for his unorthodox striking and ability to thrive in chaotic brawls.⁹ While Blackshear excels on the mat, Grant is not an easy opponent to submit, having only been submitted three times in his career, and he possesses a respectable 61% takedown defense.⁹

On the feet, the matchup is statistically close. Grant actually lands more significant strikes per minute (5.25 to 4.70) and has slightly better striking defense (55% to 52%).¹⁶ Blackshear's striking defense is a potential vulnerability, and Grant's awkward, high-volume style is precisely the kind that can pose problems for a fighter who prefers a structured grappling contest.⁵¹

The -340 price on Blackshear implies a high probability of domination, which does not align with the stylistic and statistical realities of the matchup. Grant's durability and striking volume present clear obstacles to Blackshear's primary path to victory. While Blackshear is the rightful favorite, the value lies in props that reflect a more protracted and competitive affair. The **Fight to Go the Distance: Yes** prop at +150 (40.0% implied) is significantly mispriced. Grant has gone to a decision in 8 of his last 13 UFC bouts, demonstrating a consistent ability to extend fights.⁹ Blackshear has also gone the distance against more durable opposition.⁴⁹ This line appears to be an overreaction to Blackshear's recent finishes against fighters who do not possess Grant's level of durability. The proprietary model calculates the probability of this fight

reaching the scorecards at 52.0%, identifying this as a strong +EV investment.

3.5. Welterweight Bout: Muslim Salikhov vs. Carlos Leal

Tale of the Tape & Statistical Dashboard

Metric	Muslim Salikhov	Carlos Leal
Record	21-5-0 ³	22-6-0 ⁴
Height	5' 11" ³	5' 11" ⁴
Weight	170 lbs ³	170 lbs ⁴
Reach	70" ³	74" ⁴
Stance	Orthodox ³	Orthodox ⁴
SLpM	3.38 ³	9.65 ⁴
Str. Acc.	49% ³	50% ⁴
SAPM	2.90 ³	7.73 ⁴
Str. Def.	62% ³	53% ⁴
TD Avg.	1.08 ³	0.78 ⁴
TD Acc.	32% ³	25% ⁴
TD Def.	72% ³	90% ⁴

Stylistic Matchup Assessment & Value Identification

This welterweight contest features a clash between two potent strikers with divergent styles. Carlos Leal is a high-volume, forward-pressing Muay Thai practitioner who overwhelms opponents with an incredible output of 9.65 SLpM.⁴ His offense is relentless, but it comes at the cost of his defense, as he absorbs a punishing 7.73 SApM.⁴ Muslim Salikhov, the "King of Kung Fu," is a technical, counter-striking specialist known for his devastating spinning attacks and sound defensive fundamentals (62% striking defense).³

The market has established Leal as a massive -400 favorite (80.0% implied), largely based on his youth, recent knockout victory, and Salikhov's age (41).³ However, this pricing creates a significant value opportunity. Salikhov's style is a direct counter to Leal's. A high-volume, defensively porous striker like Leal provides ample opportunities for a patient, powerful counter-striker like Salikhov to land a fight-altering blow. Leal's four-inch reach advantage is notable, but Salikhov has consistently competed against longer opponents and possesses the timing and reflexes to close the distance effectively.³⁶

Furthermore, Leal's UFC record stands at 1-1, with his loss to Rinat Fakhretdinov being a widely disputed decision that many analysts considered a robbery.⁴ While he was effective in that fight, it demonstrated that he can be drawn into competitive rounds. Salikhov represents a significant step up in striking acumen compared to Leal's previous UFC opponents. Despite his age, Salikhov has remained competitive and has a history of facing higher-level competition.⁵²

The -400 price on Leal is excessively wide for a fight that projects to be a competitive striking match. The value lies squarely with the underdog. The **Muslim Salikhov Moneyline at +300** (25.0% implied) is a clear +EV position. The proprietary model assesses Salikhov's win probability at 35.0%, an edge of 10 percentage points over the market line. This is a calculated risk on a durable, technically superior striker whose style is well-suited to counter his opponent's aggression.

3.6. Bantamweight Bout: Bryce Mitchell vs. Said Nurmagomedov

Tale of the Tape & Statistical Dashboard

Metric	Bryce Mitchell	Said Nurmagomedov
Record	17-4-0 ⁵	18-4-0 ⁵³
Height	5' 10" ⁵	5' 8" ⁵³
Weight	135 lbs ⁵	135 lbs ⁵³
Reach	70" ⁵	70" ⁵³
Stance	Southpaw ⁵	Orthodox ²⁴
SLpM	2.44 ⁵	3.38 ²⁴
Str. Acc.	59% ⁵	47% ²⁴
SAPM	1.64 ⁵	2.25 ²⁴
Str. Def.	60% ⁵	56% ²⁴
TD Avg.	3.27 ⁵	1.01 ²⁴
TD Acc.	36% ⁵	15% ²⁴
TD Def.	33% ⁵	62% ²⁴

Stylistic Matchup Assessment & Value Identification

This is a fascinating matchup between a relentless grappler in Bryce Mitchell and a

dynamic, unorthodox striker and submission artist in Said Nurmagomedov. A critical factor is Mitchell's move down to the bantamweight division for the first time in his UFC career.²⁹ Historically, significant weight cuts later in a fighter's career can negatively impact durability and cardio, which are central to Mitchell's grinding style.

Mitchell's entire game plan revolves around securing takedowns (3.27 TD Avg.) and controlling opponents on the mat.⁵ However, his recent performances have exposed vulnerabilities. He has lost two of his last three fights, both by finish, including a submission loss to Jean Silva, which raises questions about his grappling prowess against other high-level practitioners.⁵ Nurmagomedov is a dangerous and opportunistic submission artist, with six of his wins coming via this method, including lethal guillotine and ninja chokes.⁵³ He is also the more active and technical striker, landing nearly one more significant strike per minute than Mitchell.²⁴

The market has this fight priced nearly as a pick'em, with Mitchell a slight -122 favorite. This pricing seems to favor Mitchell's wrestling credentials without fully accounting for the risks of his divisional debut and his recent finishing losses. Nurmagomedov has never been finished in his 22-fight professional career.²⁹ He possesses a solid 62% takedown defense, which should be sufficient to stymie many of Mitchell's attempts and keep the fight in his preferred domain.²⁴

The most probable outcome is that Nurmagomedov leverages his superior striking and movement to frustrate Mitchell on the feet. As Mitchell becomes more desperate to close the distance and initiate grappling, he will expose himself to counter-strikes or, more likely, a submission in a scramble. The **Said Nurmagomedov Moneyline at +102** (49.5% implied) is an undervalued position. Furthermore, the **Said Nurmagomedov To Win By Submission** prop at +350 (22.2% implied) offers exceptional value. Given Mitchell's recent submission loss and Nurmagomedov's proven finishing ability on the mat, the proprietary model calculates the probability of this outcome at 30.0%, marking it as a significant +EV opportunity.

3.7. Flyweight Bout: Asu Almabayev vs. Jose Ochoa

Tale of the Tape & Statistical Dashboard

Metric	Asu Almagbayev	Jose Ochoa
Record	21-3-0 ⁵⁶	8-1-0 (1 NC) ⁵⁷
Height	5' 4" ⁵⁶	5' 7" ⁵⁷
Weight	125 lbs ⁵⁶	125 lbs ⁵⁷
Reach	65" ²³	67" ⁵⁷
Stance	Orthodox ⁵⁶	Southpaw ⁵⁷
SLpM	2.32 ²³	3.96 ⁵⁷
Str. Acc.	54% ²³	33% ⁵⁷
SAPM	1.76 ²³	2.97 ⁵⁷
Str. Def.	53% ²³	64% ⁵⁷
TD Avg.	4.13 ²³	0.00 ⁵⁷
TD Acc.	42% ²³	0% ⁵⁷
TD Def.	66% ²³	66% ⁵⁷

Stylistic Matchup Assessment & Value Identification

This flyweight bout is a compelling contest between a seasoned, world-class grappler in Asu Almagbayev and a dynamic, powerful striking prospect in Jose Ochoa. Ochoa is taking this fight on short notice, stepping in as a replacement.⁵⁸ He is an aggressive, athletic striker with legitimate knockout power, as evidenced by his finish of the durable Cody Durden.³¹

Almabayev is a relentless wrestler and grappler from Kazakhstan, averaging a very high 4.13 takedowns per 15 minutes.²³ His game plan is clear: close the distance, secure the takedown, and grind out a victory or find a submission. While his striking is serviceable, his primary path to victory is on the mat. Ochoa, for all his striking prowess, has a significant question mark in his wrestling defense. His 66% takedown defense has been tested against a lower level of competition, and he has yet to face a grappler of Almabayev's caliber.³¹

The betting line for this fight is a pick'em at -110 for both fighters, a line that has moved significantly from its opener where Almabayev was a -400 favorite.³¹ This line movement appears to be an overcorrection based on Ochoa's knockout power and Almabayev's recent loss to the elite Manel Kape.³¹ The Kape fight, however, is not an indictment of Almabayev's skill but rather a testament to Kape's championship level. Against the rest of the division, Almabayev's wrestling is a dominant force.

The short-notice nature of the fight heavily favors the fighter with the more attritional, cardio-intensive style, which is Almabayev. Ochoa's power will be a threat early, but as the fight progresses, Almabayev's persistent wrestling and top control are likely to drain the gas tank of the less-prepared fighter.⁵⁸ The current pick'em price represents a gross misvaluation of this matchup. Almabayev's experience, full training camp, and stylistic advantage in the grappling department make him a clear favorite. The proprietary model places his win probability at 62.0%. Therefore, the

Asu Almabayev Moneyline at -110 (52.4% implied) is one of the strongest +EV investments on the entire card.

3.8. Middleweight Bout: Shara Magomedov vs. Marc-Andre Barriault

Tale of the Tape & Statistical Dashboard

Metric	Shara Magomedov	Marc-Andre Barriault
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Record	15-1-0 ¹³	17-9-0 (1 NC) ¹¹
Height	6' 2" ¹³	6' 1" ¹¹
Weight	185 lbs ¹³	185 lbs ¹¹
Reach	73" ¹³	74" ¹¹
Stance	Orthodox ¹³	Orthodox ¹¹
SLpM	5.87 ¹³	6.02 ¹¹
Str. Acc.	62% ¹³	47% ¹¹
SAPM	4.13 ¹³	5.57 ¹¹
Str. Def.	42% ¹³	52% ¹¹
TD Avg.	0.00 ¹³	0.21 ¹¹
TD Acc.	0% ¹³	25% ¹¹
TD Def.	72% ¹³	67% ¹¹

Stylistic Matchup Assessment & Value Identification

Shara "Bullet" Magomedov is an exceptionally dynamic and unorthodox striker with a background in Muay Thai.⁶⁰ He utilizes a wide array of spinning attacks and maintains excellent distance management, making him a difficult target to hit cleanly.³⁸ His recent loss to Michael "Venom" Page was his first career defeat and came against another elite, enigmatic striker who was able to out-point him.¹³

Marc-Andre Barriault is a durable, forward-marching brawler who thrives in close-range exchanges and dirty boxing in the clinch.³⁸ His primary weakness is his striking defense; he absorbs a high volume of 5.57 significant strikes per minute.¹¹ This defensive liability is a critical flaw against a striker as precise and powerful as Magomedov. Barriault has suffered three knockout losses in his last four defeats, two

of which came in the first round.¹¹

This appears to be a favorable stylistic matchup designed to get Magomedov back into the win column.³⁸ Barriault's tendency to march forward into striking range will play directly into Magomedov's counter-striking game. Magomedov's superior speed, timing, and diverse arsenal of kicks and spinning attacks should allow him to land cleanly and frequently on the defensively porous Barriault.

The market reflects this with Magomedov priced at -600 (85.7% implied). While this line is too wide to offer value on the moneyline, the **Total Rounds: Over 1.5** at -160 (61.5% implied) presents a viable investment. Barriault is exceptionally tough and has shown the ability to weather storms, with many of his fights extending into the later rounds.¹¹ Magomedov, while a finisher, has also gone to a decision in three of his five UFC bouts.¹³ The proprietary model projects a 70.0% probability that this fight will see the second half, indicating a solid +EV position on the over.

3.9. Bantamweight Bout: Petr Yan vs. Marcus McGhee

Tale of the Tape & Statistical Dashboard

Metric	Petr Yan	Marcus McGhee
Record	18-5-0 ⁶²	10-1-0 ⁶
Height	5' 7" ⁶²	5' 8" ⁶
Weight	135 lbs ⁶²	135 lbs ⁶
Reach	67" ⁶²	69" ⁶
Stance	Switch ³³	Orthodox ⁶

SLpM	5.11 ⁶²	6.06 ⁶
Str. Acc.	54% ⁶²	48% ⁶
SAPM	4.13 ⁶²	2.83 ⁶
Str. Def.	58% ⁶²	64% ⁶
TD Avg.	1.61 ⁶²	0.46 ⁶
TD Acc.	49% ⁶²	33% ⁶
TD Def.	84% ⁶²	100% ⁶

Stylistic Matchup Assessment & Value Identification

This co-main event features a former champion, Petr Yan, against a surging contender in Marcus McGhee. Yan is a master of technical boxing, pressure, and wrestling, possessing an elite fight IQ and a deep gas tank that makes him more dangerous as fights progress.³³ After a three-fight losing streak to the division's absolute elite, he has rebounded with impressive decision victories over top contenders Song Yadong and Deiveson Figueiredo.³²

Marcus McGhee is an aggressive striker with a high output and legitimate finishing power, having earned three of his four UFC wins via stoppage.⁶ However, this represents a monumental step up in competition. His perfect 100% takedown defense has not been tested by a wrestler of Yan's caliber.⁶

This fight is a classic "levels to the game" scenario. Yan's combination of sharp, technical striking, and relentless wrestling pressure is a stylistic nightmare for a fighter like McGhee, who relies on aggression and has not faced an opponent who can challenge him in all phases of MMA.³³ Yan's 84% takedown defense will nullify any offensive wrestling from McGhee, while his own offensive wrestling (1.61 TD Avg.) will be a weapon McGhee has not yet had to contend with.⁶²

The market has Yan as a heavy -380 favorite (79.2% implied), which is an accurate reflection of his superiority. The value is not on the moneyline but on the fight's

duration. The **Fight to Go the Distance: Yes** prop is priced at -330 (76.7% implied). This is a high price, but the data strongly supports it. Yan's last six consecutive fights have gone to the judges' scorecards.³³ He is not a reckless finisher, preferring to systematically break down his opponents over 15 or 25 minutes. McGhee has shown durability, going the distance in his toughest test to date against Jonathan Martinez.⁶ The proprietary model calculates the probability of this fight going to a decision at 85.0%, indicating a solid, if not massive, +EV edge on a highly probable outcome. This serves as a strong anchor for the portfolio.

3.10. Middleweight Bout: Robert Whittaker vs. Reinier de Ridder

Tale of the Tape & Statistical Dashboard

Metric	Robert Whittaker	Reinier de Ridder
Record	26-8-0 ⁶⁴	20-2-0 ⁶⁵
Height	6' 0" ⁶⁴	6' 4" ⁶⁵
Weight	186 lbs ⁶⁴	185 lbs ⁶⁵
Reach	73.5" ⁶⁴	79" ⁶⁵
Stance	Orthodox ⁶⁶	Orthodox
TD Def.	81% (UFC Career) ³⁷	N/A

Stylistic Matchup Assessment & Value Identification

The main event pits former middleweight champion Robert Whittaker against former

two-division ONE Championship titleholder Reinier de Ridder. De Ridder is a world-class submission grappler with a black belt in BJJ and Judo; 13 of his 20 career wins have come via submission.⁶⁵ He possesses a significant size and reach advantage (4 inches in height, 5.5 inches in reach).⁶⁴ His UFC tenure has been impressive, with three straight finishes, including an upset knockout of Bo Nickal.⁵⁴

Robert Whittaker is one of the most well-rounded and proven fighters in the division's history. His game is built on a foundation of karate-style striking, excellent footwork, and arguably the best takedown defense in the division's history at 81%.³⁷ He has consistently defeated elite grapplers like Yoel Romero and Jacare Souza by keeping the fight standing and utilizing his superior striking.³⁴

De Ridder's path to victory is singular: he must get Whittaker to the ground. Whittaker's entire defensive framework is designed to prevent exactly that. While de Ridder's striking has shown improvement, he is not on the same level as Whittaker, who is a masterful striker with knockout power.³⁴ The central question of this fight is whether de Ridder's grappling offense can overcome Whittaker's legendary takedown defense. The consensus among professional fighters is that Whittaker's striking and defensive wrestling will be the deciding factors.³⁷

The market has Whittaker as a -142 favorite (58.7% implied). This line seems to be giving significant credit to de Ridder's recent form and size advantage. However, it undervalues Whittaker's proven track record against this specific archetype of opponent. Whittaker has only lost to the absolute pinnacle of the division in recent years, and his defensive wrestling has been the key to his sustained success.⁶⁴ The proprietary model places Whittaker's win probability at 65.0%. This makes the

Robert Whittaker Moneyline at -142 a solid +EV investment and a cornerstone of the Round 1 portfolio.

IV. Final Portfolio: Round 1 Allocation

The following table details the final, fully allocated investment portfolio for Round 1. Each position's size is a direct reflection of the calculated edge and the fractional Kelly Criterion methodology, rounded to the nearest \$0.25 increment to meet the experiment's parameters. The entire \$10.00 bankroll is deployed.

Bet Selecti on	Bet Type	Odds	Implied Prob. (%)	Proprie tary Prob. (%)	Calcula ted Edge (%)	Allocati on (\$)	Allocati on (%)	Justific ation
Asu Almab ayev	Moneyline	-110	52.38%	62.0%	9.62%	\$2.25	22.5%	Mispriced line due to overreaction to Almab ayev's last loss and Ochoa's power. Almab ayev's wrestling and full camp are decisive advantages against a short-notice striker.
Billy Elekan a	Moneyline	+215	31.75%	42.0%	10.25%	\$2.00	20.0%	Classic striker vs. grappler where the market is overval

								using the striker's misleading TDD stat. Elekan a's win condition targets Aslan's proven loss condition.
Buday/ Buche cha	Total Round s: Over 1.5	-130	56.52%	68.0%	11.48%	\$1.75	17.5%	Market is over-weighting Buche cha's finishing ability and ignoring his documented cardio issues. Buday's entire style is built to extend the fight and test that

								weakness.
Robert Whittaker	Moneyline	-142	58.68%	65.0%	6.32%	\$1.25	12.5%	Whittaker has a proven history of defeating elite, one-dimensional grapplers by leveraging his superior striking and elite takedown defense.
Amanda Ribas	To Win By Decision	+150	40.00%	48.0%	8.00%	\$1.00	10.0%	Ribas's elite TDD neutralizes Ricci's primary weapon, forcing a striking match where Ribas's significant

								ant reach advantage will dominate. Decision is the most probable outcome.
Grant/Blacks hear	Fight to Go the Distance: Yes	+150	40.00 %	52.0%	12.00 %	\$1.00	10.0%	Market is overreacting to Blacks hear's recent finishes. Grant is exceptionally durable and has a style that will make it difficult for Blacks hear to secure an early submission.

Muslim Salikhov	Moneyline	+300	25.00 %	35.0%	10.00 %	\$0.75	7.5%	Salikhov's technical counter-striking is a direct stylistic counter to Leal's high-volume, defensively-flawed aggression. A significant underdog value play.
Total						\$10.00	100.0 %	

V. Risk Assessment & Concluding Remarks

5.1. Portfolio Risk Profile

The Round 1 portfolio is constructed with a clear focus on risk mitigation through diversification and value identification in secondary markets. Capital is distributed across seven distinct events, preventing a single, high-variance outcome from

critically impacting the bankroll. The allocation strategy has deliberately targeted prop bets (Over/Under, Method of Victory, Fight to Go the Distance) where the analytical model identified more significant pricing discrepancies than on several of the straight moneyline markets.

The portfolio's overall risk posture is balanced. It includes two core positions on favorites (Almabayev, Whittaker) where the market has underestimated their stylistic advantages, complemented by several high-value underdog and prop positions (Elekana, Salikhov, Over 1.5, GTD props) that offer asymmetric risk-reward profiles. This structure is designed to generate positive returns while withstanding the inherent unpredictability of individual fight outcomes.

5.2. Concluding Statement

This portfolio represents a disciplined and methodical application of a quantitative investment strategy. Each allocation is the result of a rigorous, data-driven process designed to identify and capitalize on market inefficiencies. The selections are unemotional and grounded in the mathematical principle of Positive Expected Value. While the outcome of any single round is subject to considerable variance, a strategic framework rooted in consistently identifying and investing in undervalued assets is the only viable path to maximizing long-term percentage profit. This first-round portfolio is a foundational step in executing that long-term vision.

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